Guidelines for Presenters at the Research Colloquium

A colloquium is a learning event during which a research degree candidate presents the main feature of his or her research and a group of people including some experienced supervisors and examiners comment on the work. In addition to obtaining direct feedback on their own work the research degree candidates have the opportunity to see how others are proceeding with their research and listen to the other feedback given. For a colloquium to be of value the research candidate needs to have begun the voyage of discovery and for those who are reasonably well advanced they should be looking to obtain help in deciding how to finish off the research. However, even those who have made only a small amount of progress will find the colloquium useful. A colloquium is also an excellent networking opportunity.

The format of the colloquium involves the researcher presenting for a short period, in this case 10 minutes, while being listened to by a group and then hearing comments. Some colloquia will also offer short written comments to the researcher. Only constructive criticism will be offered during a colloquium.

The following are the topics which the research degree candidate should include even if only to say that work on a particular issue has not yet commenced but that the researcher is aware of what needs to be done.

1. At what stage in the process of the research degree are you currently engaged?
2. What is your research problem and/or research question?
3. Why is your research problem and/or research question important and to whom is it interesting?
4. Which established authors in your field of study have influenced your thinking the most?
5. How would you describe your underpinning research philosophy? Are you an interpretivist or a positivist or do you perceive yourself to be a multi-methods person?
6. What sources of data have you accessed and how have you processed the data?
7. What are your principal findings and what application might there be for your findings?
8. Do you have any comments about the limitations of your research and future related research?

In the time allotted these issues can only be addressed at a high level and the number of presentation slides used should be kept to a minimum. It is recommended that only 5 slides be used. Please follow the presentation guidelines from here:

http://academic-conferences.org/conference-presentation-guidelines.htm

Professor Dan Remenyi 2014